earlier ‘bipolar’ model that was based on a duality between the East and the West.

Despite an economic crisis in the traditional Superpower countries, which include the EU and the United States, have continued to hegemonize international forums and institutions around the world, for instance, the World Bank, the International Monetary Fund (IMF), the G-8,[3] and G-20,[4] which were largely West-dominated. It has led to the need for new formations, and the ‘BRICS’ (Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa)[5] was thus conceptualized and established in 2009.

The aim of BRICS was evident at the outset: the reform of the international financial and political system through such a parallel new forum (First BRIC Summit declaration 2009). In a 2014 meeting at the Brazil Summit, BRICS took essential steps to create an ‘Infrastructural and new development bank’[6] (Fortaleza BRICS Summit declaration 2014). Russia and China had a particular interest in BRICS, mainly because they believed it would differ from the G-8 and G-77[7] groups. It provided them with the opportunity to take positions that could help to enhance both Russian and Chinese foreign policy interests in international relations.

Background

The disintegration of the Soviet Union (SU) in 1991 is considered a watershed moment in contemporary world politics. It paved the way for the end of the Cold War and triggered a unipolar[8] moment in international politics under the US hegemony. The United States became the sole Superpower in global politics within every domain—military, economic, and socio-cultural. While it signaled an end to bloc politics, it unchained many Third World countries from the constraints imposed by the Cold War and gave these countries the scope to exercise autonomy within foreign policies. With rapid economic growth, expanding international trade, and technological revolutions, the world order became more complex, and interdependence and inter-connectedness deepened. While the United States remains highly powerful, alternate power centers have emerged to contribute to world politics significantly.

The equation between these power centers came closest to the system of multiple powers, unlike the bipolar dominance during the Cold War period